

A Star Fleet Battles™ Scenario

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(SG __.0) A GAME OF TRACTORS

This is a training scenario, loosely based on a sport from the Central Asia region of Earth, where horse-mounted warriors turned hunting traditions into a game called "Kok Boru" in some places, and known as "Buzkashi" or "Qarajai" in others.

(SG __.1) NUMBER OF PLAYERS: 4 minimum, split into 2 teams (Red and Blue), at least 2 players *per* team.

(SG __.2) INITIAL SETUP:

TERRAIN: None (see (SG __.41))

SHIPS: Each team has 560 BPV to select four (no more, no less) ships; each ship may be either Size Class 3 or 4, and must have at least one Tractor Beam (Andromedan Tractor-Repulsor Beams qualify). Players must agree to allow ships equipped with any of the following: Displacement Devices, Web Casters. If any of those technologies are allowed, then ships with Scout Channels must also be allowed (including a SWACS).

BLUE TEAM: All ships are placed in hex 2101, speed 0, facing any, WS-III. The Goal (SG __.48) for this Team is hex 0315.

RED TEAM: All ships are placed in hex 2230, speed 0, facing any, WS-III. The Goal (SG __.48) for this Team is hex 3915.

YEAR: This is set in Y182, but players may agree to use a different year, which may affect available ships and refits.

(SH __.3) LENGTH OF SCENARIO: Scenario continues until pre-agreed conclusion (*e.g.*, first Team to score a certain number of points, elapsed time, points lead, *etc.*), which should include how to resolve a tie (*e.g.*, overtime, sudden death).

(SG __.4) SPECIAL RULES:

(SG __.41) MAP: The map is fixed and bounded by a (P17.0) Tournament Barrier.

(SG __.42) SHUTTLES AND PFs: There are no PFs in this scenario; shuttles (and fighters) are present only as apropos to selected ships (but upgrades those units are discouraged, for reasons which should be obvious). Any improvements or upgrades (for example, an MRS or Warp Booster Packs) are paid for out of the 560 BPV.

(SG __.43) COMMANDER'S OPTION ITEMS:

(SG __.431): Each ship can have additional or special equipment as Commander's Option Items (*e.g.*, T-bombs, *etc.*), up to 20% of its combat BPV, but the total BPV expended by each Team may not exceed 560. See (S3.2) for details and exceptions if both Teams agree to their use.

(SG __.432): All drones are "fast"; speed 32, unless the Year is set when that speed is not available. Each drone armed ship can select special drones up to the historical percentages, except that Slug drones (FD13.0) have General Availability (FD10.61). While (S3.2) allows drone ships other exemptions for similar purpose, the total BPV expended by each Team still may not exceed 560. Drones have little utility in this scenario except in an anti-ESG role.

(SG __.433): Players must adhere to historical availability and deployment rules when selecting upgrades and special

equipment. All Tugs and Pods are prohibited regardless.

(SG __.434): Similar to drones, mines have little utility in this scenario, except in either anti-ESG or anti-drone roles.

(SG __.435): Wild Weasels should be considered "banned" as a practical matter; they have no real purpose in this scenario. If someone absolutely insists on using them, then they are treated as an identified Suicide Shuttle for rules controlling what can be done to them (SG __.4613).

(SG __.44) REFITS: Any ship may receive any Refit(s) for which it is eligible, but the total BPV expended by each Team still may not exceed 560.

(SG __.45) BALL: The ball is not a "unit" within the general SFB terminology. It is a relatively small physical object with highly unusual properties.

(SG __.451): The ball is a Size Class 5 object.

(SG __.452): The ball does not: have an SSD, weapons or shields; generate power or Electronic Warfare points; perform Energy Allocation.

(SG __.453): The ball cannot be damaged, destroyed, placed in stasis, displaced, transported, brought into a shuttle bay, or lent ECM. It cannot trigger mines, impact any other object or unit, or damage a player unit.

(SG __.454): The ball is not affected by explosions (*e.g.*, as caused by mines or ships), or Wild Weasel collateral damage. It does not interact with an ESG, webs or terrain.

(SG __.455): At the start of the scenario, and after each goal is scored (SG __.48), the ball is placed in hex 2115.

(SG __.456): The ball cannot move by itself; it may only be moved *via* Tractor Beam (G7.0). For the purposes of (G7.321), the ball has a Movement Cost of 0.125; it is always considered a "friendly" (G7.213) unit. The ball is subject to tractor rotation under (G7.7). For multiple-tractor attempts, use (G7.37) to resolve.

(SG __.457): If the ball is tractored and for any reason strikes the Tournament Barrier, the tractor link is broken (G7.723); exception (SG __.482).

(SG __.46) COMBAT: This is not a combat scenario. Player units may not fire any weapons at other players units (note the use of the word "units"; the prohibition is not limited to ships), including direct-fire and seeking weapons; exceptions (SG __.461) (SG __.465) (SG __.467). However, damage may occur in certain circumstances, and is resolved (and repaired) normally.

(SG __.461): Certain systems are not considered "weapons" within the scope of (SG __.46):

(SG __.4611): Tholian Web Casters (E12.0), if not fired as a Web Fist (E14.0); and, Web Snares (E13.0); are not considered a weapon. However, for Web Casters, the (E12.51) maximum range is reduced to 15 hexes; see also (SG __.482). The main utility would be to break a tractor link under (G10.71), but it is possible for a cast web to incidentally damage player units under (G10.59),

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and such an event is not considered as firing a weapon.

(SG____.4612): An Andromedan ship equipped with a Displacement Device (G18.0) may displace player units. When used against units of the other Team under (G18.321), use double the actual effective range when resolving success under (G18.32); when an Andromedan uses a Displacement Device on a friendly unit, then resolve normally (but still distinguish between Andromedan and non-Andromedan friendly units).

(SG____.4613): Players may use tractor beams on other player units. However, non-seeking shuttles may not be "death-dragged" under (G7.54); any attempt to do so automatically breaks the tractor link, including for crippled units, non-fighter shuttles, and regardless of any other rule that would prevent the shuttle's escape. All shuttles escaping destruction using this rule are still under the restrictions imposed by (G7.55), even if they do not perform an HET (that is, a fighter would use the rules normally, although it would always be eligible, even if the normal rules indicated it were not; non-fighter units that ordinarily could not break away are enabled to do so, but they do not actually perform an HET as part of the maneuver). A Scatterpack or Suicide Shuttle that has not been identified as such is treated as if it were manned for the purposes of this rule. A Wild Weasel is treated as an unmanned seeking shuttle.

(SG____.462): Ships may use Electronic Warfare, including - if appropriate - Offensive EW (E24.219). Generally, in this scenario, EW does not have much value (for example, it cannot break lock-ons or a tractor link). However, Offensive EW may be useful as a method to prevent successful operation of a Web Caster (E12.56) or Displacement Device (G18.32). Units such as an MRS may be deployed by ships which historically carried them.

(SG____.463): An ESG (G23.0) is not "fired" in the normal sense of a direct-fire weapon. An ESG may be activated when the ESG-equipped unit is within three hexes of the ball, and under the following additional restrictions.

(SG____.4631): If activation is announced and the ball is moved more than three hexes away before the ESG is released, then the activation must be cancelled (G23.33) if possible, or the field immediately dropped (G23.47) if not.

(SG____.4632): A use for an ESG would be to create a bubble around a ship in possession of the ball and make it difficult for other ships to approach close enough to engage in a tractor auction. As long as ship generating the ESG remains within three hexes of the ball, it may keep the ESG active, and is under

no obligation to avoid damaging other units that deliberately approach it or allow themselves to be hit by the ESG field. By the same token, no other unit is required to avoid being hit by the ESG. However, in order to qualify for an exemption from the prohibition against damaging other units, the ESG-equipped ship must move towards the Goal for its Team as if it were a seeking weapon (F2.2); if an ESG-generating ship moves in a way that would not be acceptable for a seeking weapon, then the ESG-generating ship is treated as if it had violated the prohibition should it subsequently cause any damage to an enemy unit. This remains in effect until all ESGs are dropped and the ship moves such that it is more than three hexes from the ball.

(SG____.4633): If, at the end of any MOVEMENT SEGMENT (6A), the ball located more than three hexes from a ship generating an ESG, the field must be dropped during the ESG Step of the SEEKING WEAPONS STAGE (6B6) of the same impulse.

(SG____.4634): An ESG that contacts a Goal hex is immediately reduced to 0 strength during the DAMAGE DURING MOVEMENT STAGE, but the generating unit takes no damage. Any other unit that might have come into contact with the ESG during that movement is not damaged (that is, contact with the Goal hex is resolved first; this creates a technical exception to (G23.52)).

(SG____.464): Similarly, mines are not "fired", and they may be deployed in accordance with the normal rules and the following restrictions.

(SG____.4641): Mines may not be placed within seven hexes of a Goal. Any mine violating this rule explodes immediately upon deployment (even if not normally eligible to detonate), but can *only* damage the unit laying the mine (and only if the laying unit is within the explosion zone). Even if other units are within the explosion zone, they are not damaged. A "dummy" mine is merely revealed as such. Mines may not use (M2.15).

(SG____.4642): Explosive mines may only be deployed in anti-ESG (G23.61) and/or anti-seeking weapon roles. If cloaking devices are in use, then mines may also be employed in an anti-cloak (G13.552) role. If not deployed in an anti-cloak role, then mines **must** use (M2.14) and cannot be set for Size Class 4 or larger targets. If a cloak-equipped ship is in use, then mines may also be set to accept the Size Class of any ship equipped with a cloak.

(SG____.4643): Explosive mines interact with ESGs normally (G23.6) and if such an interaction damages player units, that does not violate the combat prohibition of (SG____.46). Similarly, if a

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mine is triggered by a seeking weapon, or a Cloak-capable ship (whether it is cloaked at that moment or not) or another ship of the same Size Class, any damage caused by the mine does not violate the combat prohibition of (SG____.46).

(SG____.4644): All mines on the map harmlessly self-destruct when a Goal (SG____.483) is scored; "dummy" mines are notable in that they vanish without exploding. Mines still aboard units are not affected.

(SG____.465): Seeking weapons may be launched, but only targeted on other seeking weapons (a shuttlecraft must have been identified as a Scatterpack or a Suicide Shuttle, or it is not a "seeking weapon" and does not have to be announced as such) or to attempt to trigger mines (however, there is no "anti-cloak" role for seeking weapons); "slug" drones (FD13.0) and "null" drones, as well as ECM drones and plasmas, are not "weapons" prohibited by (SG____.46); this means that drones with explosive payloads may not be deliberately used in an "anti-ESG" role (if such a drone was launched to counter another drone and happened to collide with an ESG, that is not "deliberate"). When a Goal is scored, **all** in-flight seeking weapons go inert and are removed from the map, regardless of remaining endurance.

(SG____.466): Cloaking Devices (G13.0) are not weapons and their use is not restricted. Additionally, a properly-equipped and otherwise eligible ship that has tractor the ball may use a cloaking device subject to the following rules:

(SG____.4661): Since activating the cloaking device requires the ship to turn off fire control, the tractor link to the ball must be established before activation (D6.24). If the cloaked ship subsequently loses that link, for any reason, then it will be unable to re-tractor the ball until it uncloaks.

(SG____.4662): An existing tractor link to the ball does not void the cloak; however, any other action, by the cloaked ship, that would normally void a cloak, will do so. The cloak may also be voided under other circumstances (mines, webs, *etc*), *per* those rules.

(SG____.4663): Other ships attempting to retain (or regain) a lock-on to the cloaked ship do so normally.

(SG____.4664): Only the cloaking ship is covered by the cloak; the ball is not cloaked, and other units remain able to lock-on to it normally. Thus, the cloaked ship does not avoid possible multi-tractor engagements, and such events are resolved normally.

(SG____.4665): In this scenario, the cloaking device is useful for avoiding Andromedan Displacement Devices, or other ships tractor a ship that has tractor the ball. Also, since the ball does not trigger mines, a cloaked ship with the ball may be

able to slip past them (G13.55).

(SG____.467): The prohibition against attacking "units" does not prevent players from destroying (under the other applicable rules) seeking weapons (including Suicide Shuttles that have been identified as such), and/or mines that are being used in an anti-ESG role (or mines that may have been deployed in an anti-cloak role).

(SG____.468): Boarding actions are **always** prohibited combat. Ships may not be captured, or damaged *via* Hit and Run Raids.

(SG____.469): A tractor beam applied to an enemy ship does not violate the combat prohibition of (SG____.46), even if it is used to, for example, push/rotate the enemy ship into a mine, web hex or into an active ESG.

(SG____.47) CONSEQUENCES OF VIOLATING COMBAT PROHIBITION: If a ship violates the prohibition against combat, then apply as many of the following, as match the circumstances, as penalties for doing so. All penalties immediately cease if a Goal is scored (SG____.483).

(SG____.471): All tractor beams generated by the ship are immediately broken. Even if the ship has available, unused tractor beams and sufficient power, it cannot operate any tractors for 33 impulses after the violation. It still may generate negative tractor.

(SG____.472): The ship immediately switches to Passive Fire Control (D19.0). It cannot switch back to Active Fire Control for 33 impulses after the violation. If the ship is guiding seeking weapons, control must be transferred or the weapons become inert and are removed from play.

(SG____.473): If the ship is generating an ESG, the ESG field is immediately dropped (G23.47); if an activation has been announced but the field has not been released, then the activation must be cancelled (G23.33) if possible, or the field immediately dropped if not. Even if the ship has other ESGs and sufficient power, it cannot operate any ESGs for 33 impulses after the violation.

(SG____.474): If a ship violates the combat prohibition while cloaked, the cloak is immediately voided and the cloaking device is deactivated. If the ship is in the process of fade-out, then it stops fade-out and begins fade-in. If a cloaking device-equipped ship violates the combat prohibition while not cloaked, then it may not activate its cloaking device for 33 impulses after the violation.

(SG____.475): The ship cannot deploy mines (by any means), or launch shuttlecraft, for 33 impulses after the violation. It may still recover shuttlecraft (if allowed under normal rules).

(SG____.476): The ship cannot launch any seeking weapons, even ballistically, for 33 impulses after the violation.

(SG____.477): The ship cannot execute an HET, begin Erratic Maneuvering, or use reserve power for unplotted mid-turn speed changes, for 33 impulses after the violation. If the ship is using EM, then EM immediately stops. The ship still may change speed as plotted for the turn, and also may execute an Emergency Deceleration.

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(SG __.48) GOALS AND SCORING:

(SG __.481): Each Team has a Goal (SG __.2).

(SG __.482): A Goal hex functions (with a few exceptions noted here) as a Tournament Barrier (P17.0) for player units, but not the ball. If a player unit attempts to enter a Goal hex, it stops without entering the hex; in an exception, the Goal hex (or being stopped by it) does not break a tractor link to, or created by, any player ship. Player units cannot be displaced into a Goal hex (if displacement result causes a player unit to land in a Goal hex, reduce the number of hexes moved by one). A cast web (or snare) cannot include a Goal hex, or any hex that is within four hexes of a Goal hex (the portion of a cast web/snare that violates this rule immediately dissipates without effect, but the rest of the cast web/snare will function normally). See also (SG __.4634) and (SG __.4641).

(SG __.483): When the ball is moved into a Team's Goal, and remains in the Goal hex for four consecutive impulses, the Team scores a point and the current Turn ends. All player units return to their starting positions (SG __.2) and perform Energy Allocation for the new Turn. The ball is placed in hex 2115.

(SG __.4831): If the ball does not remain in the Goal hex for four consecutive impulses, then no point is scored and play continues. Any future impulse count starts from zero (not from where it was when the ball left the Goal hex).

(SG __.4832): The counting of impulses begins with the DAMAGE DURING MOVEMENT STAGE (6A3) of the Sequence of Play. For example, the ball is moved into the Team's Goal on Impulse #10; if it is still in the Goal hex at the end of (6A2) of Impulse #14, a point is scored.

(SG __.4833): The ball may remain or be tractoried while in the Goal hex without affecting the count of impulses. However, while in the Goal hex, the ball has an effective Negative Tractor (G7.35) equal to the range from a unit attempting to tractor it. An exception is the unit that was tractoried the ball when it was moved into the Goal hex; that unit is not affected unless and until it releases the ball, after which it is affected as long as the ball remains in the Goal hex (the purpose of this rule is to make it difficult for an enemy to casually dislodge the ball from the Goal hex from a distance).

(SG __.4834): The impulse count may extend across a turn break.

(SG __.5) VICTORY CONDITIONS: See (SG __.3).

(SG __.6) VARIATIONS: Without losing sight of (SG __.7), there are some reasonable changes to introduce variations to this scenario. These mainly revolve around specific combinations of empires/technologies.

(SG __.61) Kzinti vs. Lyran: Allow the Kzinti players to ignore historical limits on special drones. Permit both teams to ignore the (M3.13) limits by

allowing them to purchase explosive mines to replace the (M2.9) "dummy" mines (that is, effectively double each ships' ability to carry mines, and eliminate "fakes").

(SG __.62) Romulan (or Orion) vs. Andromedan: Can cloaked ships get the ball past the Displacement Devices, or will the Andromedans be able to leap ahead and wrest away the ball? Both will need to be wary of mines.

(SG __.63) Limited Technologies: Eliminate Lyrans (ESGs), Andromedans (Displacement Devices), Orions (engine doubling) and Neo-Tholians (Web Casters). Also prohibit scout functions, cloaking devices, mines, suicide shuttles and drones.

(SG __.64) PFs Only: Instead of full ships, each Team has a PF Flotilla, without a Tender, consisting of six Leader variants (R1.PF6). Limit the total value of the Flotilla, including Commander's Options, to less than 360 (players should agree on the exact number as part of the initial setup; carefully consider limits on the number of PFs allowed to have WBPs). Because of the simple power allocation process for PFs, this variation may be especially good for novice players.

(SG __.65) Time To Score Goal: Vary the number of impulse the ball must remain in the Goal (SG __.483) before a point is scored.

(SG __.7) TACTICS: The purpose of this scenario is to teach the practical use of tractor beams. If allowed, Web Casters, ESGs (plus mines), Cloaks and Displacement Devices can each throw a wrinkle into the game, but never lose sight of the fact that only your tractor beams can allow you to win. Heavy War Destroyers (G33.0) may provide some of the best ships, due to their permissive modification rules. Don't forget that nothing limits your tractor beams to the ball!

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